[METRIC]
A-A-688B
July 11, 1995
SUPERSEDING
A-A-688A
September 16, 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BAG, PAPER (INSULATED)

This Commercial Item Description has been approved by the General Services Administration/Federal Supply Service.

1. Scope. This description covers two types of insulated paper bags, designed to provide thermal protection for frozen, chilled, or heated perishable foods.

2. Salient characteristics.

2.1. Construction. The material used to fabricate the bags shall conform to the requirements of this description and all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act.

2.1.1. Type I bags shall be composed of kraft paper and aluminum foil. The aluminum foil shall be the exterior of the bag. Laminating material shall be applied adequately, throughout, between the foil and paper so that the plies shall be securely anchored. Center seams and bottom seams (bottom fold) shall be formed to the rear on the same face.

2.1.2. Type II bags shall be composed of two plies of kraft paper. The inner liner may also be a wet-strength creped kraft paper with basis weight of 57 g/m^2 (35 lb, 24"x36"-500) before creping, or embossed kraft paper. The bags shall be so constructed that the face with lip, bottom and center seams or overlaps shall be to the rear. The factory-closed ends shall be adequately and securely sealed, both to the bottom of the folds and between the plies of the paper. Adhesive shall be applied in spots between the two plies at or near the top or open end of the bag to facilitate opening. Seams in successive plies shall be staggered approximately 2.5 cm (1").

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document, should be sent to: General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, 26 Federal Plaza, New York N.Y. 10278 ATTN: Engineering Branch (2FYEE).

FSC 8105

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2.2. Physical requirements. The bags shall conform to the physical requirements listed in Table I below, and in paragraph (5.3.) herein:

Table I

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Basis weight of kraft paper	65 g/m^2 ± 5% (40lb, 24"x36"- 500) ± 5%	TAPPI T-410
Bursting strength	22 point minimum	TAPPI T-403
Tearing resistance of paper	43 grams minimum, MD	TAPPI T-414
Thickness of aluminum foil	0.00762 mm ± 10% (0.0003") ± 10%	TAPPI T-411
Bag sizes *	Designed to hold: 0.473 liter (pint), 0.946 liter (quart), 1.893 liter (1/2 gallon), 3.785 liter (gallon) containers	

* Bag sizes shall be as specified in the contract or order.

2.3. Dimensions. Unless otherwise specified, the bag dimensions shall be inside measurements (Length x Width x Gusset), ± 6.4 mm (±1/4"), exclusive of lip. (See Fig. 1 for method of measuring).

3. Workmanship. The bags shall be clean, well made, neatly formed in such a manner as to lend themselves to easy handling and free from defects that may render them unserviceable, or which may result in damage to the contents.

4. Regulatory requirements. The contractor shall certify that the product offered shall include a minimum of 5% post-consumer recovered material, in accordance with Paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR). The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5. Quality assurance:

5.1. Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government

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reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2. Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes, e.g. (Statistical Process Control SPC techniques), as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3/American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. Objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document, or, herein.

End item inspection/testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. Sampling shall be in accordance with (ANSI)/(ASQC) Z1.4. An inspection lot shall consist of all bags manufactured by the same process from the same components at the same time. The sample unit shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 % defective for construction, dimensions and workmanship. The inspection level shall be S-1 with an AQL of 2.5 % defective for physical requirements.

The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

5.3. Adhesive testing. The end item shall be tested for adhesion requirements. A composite sample of 13 bags shall be randomly selected from each lot. Failure of any bag shall result in rejection of the lot.

Adhesive used in the fabrication of the bags, at the bottom seam (or fold) and center seam shall be waterproof to the extent that there shall be not less than 95% fiber failure. Testing for adhesion shall be as follows: Cut the full width of a bottom seam (or bottom fold) from the bag, the entire center seam, with not less than 12.7 mm (1/2") of paper on each side of the seam and immerse in distilled water (room temperature) at a depth of not less than 25 mm (1"). After one hour, remove the specimen from the bath and separate the seamed area by hand. Examine the pre-bonded surfaces and report the percentage of fiberless separation to the nearest percent. If the fiberless area is less than 5%, two additional specimen are to be tested in a like manner for confirmation.

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6. Packaging, Packing, and Marking: Shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

7.1. Referenced documents: The issues of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

7.1.1. Federal Regulations.

Federal Acquisition Regulation. Paragraph 23.403

Copies of the U.S. Code may be obtained through the Congressional Sales Office, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington D.C., 20402.

7.1.2. Other publications.

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 - American National Standards Institute (ANSI)/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC), Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

Available from: American Society for Quality Control, P.O. Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

TAPPI test methods T-410, T-403, T-411 and T-414.

TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, Technology Park, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

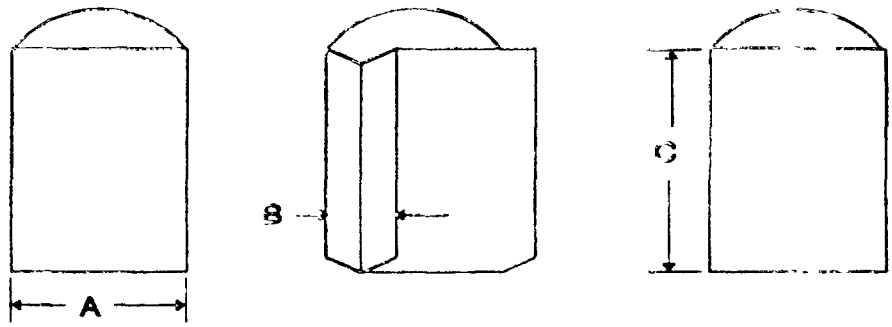
8. Ordering data. Purchasers shall specify the following in the contract or purchase order.

(a). Type and size of the bag.
(b). Packaging, packing, and marking required.

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Fig. 1

Bag style and method of measuring



Face width (A): Measure along the front face of the folded bag.
Bag gusset (B): Measure across flattened area of the bag.
Bag length (C): Measure along center of the bag face from the bottom of the top edge.

MILITARY INTEREST:

DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendment to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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